

EDGE FINISHES: Waist and sleeve bands, hems, Facings and crossway strips

Introduction

Raw edges can be finished in many different ways depending on whether the edge is meant to be visible or is intended to be a decorative addition to the garment.

Waistline Finishes

Waistlines of garments are most commonly finished with a self-fabric band, inner belting, or a built up top. First stitch and press the vertical seams, finish edges and complete the placket/opening.

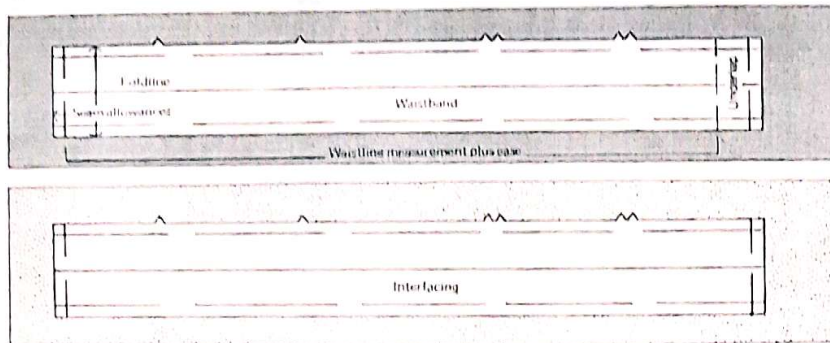
Check the position and fit of the waistline seam.

- The correct fit of waistline of a dress, skirt or trousers contributes much to the comfort and appearance of the garment.
- Before stitching the waistline seams, the garment should be fitted with the waistband or bodice temporarily in place to determine the right length of bodice, the correct position of waistline seam, and the correct waistline circumference.
- Current fashion, garment design, and body proportions must be considered in judging the correct location of the waistline.
- An easy way to find the correct waistline is to fasten a narrow belt cord or tape measure around the waist so that it fits comfortably.
- The waistline of the garment should be approximately 1.3 - 2.5 cm (1/2 - 1") larger than the actual body measurement to allow for movement and for variations in size.
- When the waistline of a dress is correctly fitted, the belt will remain over the waistline seam.

Waistbands

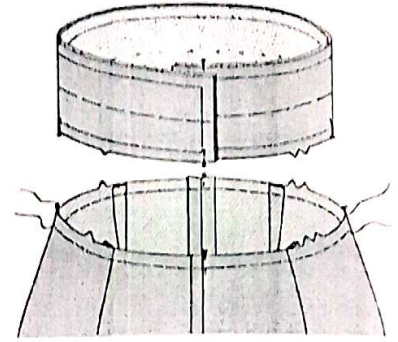
- Many types of waistbands are used in clothing construction, but generally waistbands are made from a straight strip of fabric with interfacing or backing added to provide body and prevent stretching.
- Waistbands are cut with the lengthwise grain the long direction of the band unless the crosswise grain is necessary for matching a design as in some plaids.
- Interfacings provide firmness sufficient for most fabrics.
- Backing may be used to eliminate bulk or to provide more body.

Waistband formed as it is applied

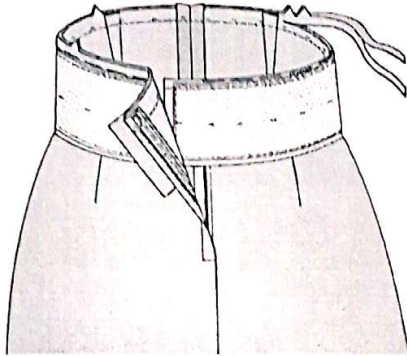


This is perhaps the most basic and traditional of all the waistband techniques. The waistband for this method is cut with an extended (self) facing and is then applied to the garment as a flat piece. The ends are formed and finished while it is being applied to the garment. If the waistband is to be cut without a pattern, determine the correct length and

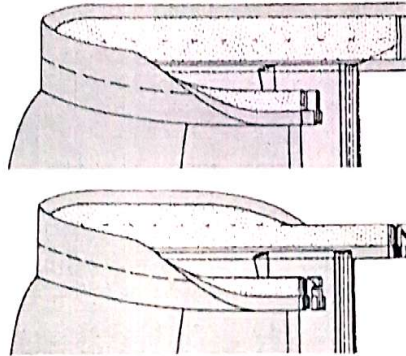
width as described on the preceding pages. The length of the waistband should be placed on the lengthwise grain of the fabric for greatest stability. Cut and apply the interfacing according to the type of interfacing that has been chosen and the number of layers being used. Mark the folding of the waistband by basting by hand through all thicknesses.



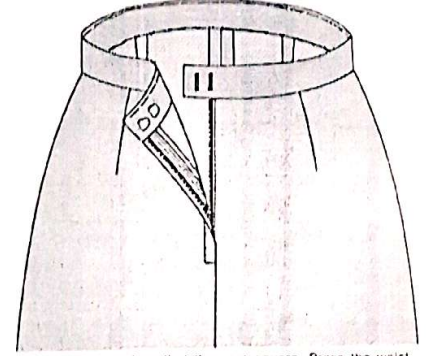
1. Pin mark waistband and garment into sections (mark the edge of the waistband that will be sewed to the garment). Place a pin at beginning of overlap or seam allowance, another at beginning of underlap. Divide remainder of band into fourths. Pin mark the garment waistline also into four equal parts, using the zipper opening as the starting point.



2. With right sides together, pin waistband to garment, matching pin marks and notches. Draw up the ease thread on garment between pins so that the fullness is evenly distributed and the garment lies flat against the waistband. Baste, then stitch, on the seamline. Press seam flat. Grade the seam allowances. Press the waistband and seam up.



3. Turn the $\frac{1}{4}$ " seam allowance on the long unstitched edge of the waistband to the wrong side and press. To finish the ends, fold the waistband along the foldline so that the waistband is wrong side out, with right sides together. Pin at each end and stitch on the $\frac{1}{4}$ " seamline. Trim both seams and corners and turn waistband right side out.



4. Pull corners out so that they are square. Press the waistband facing to the inside of the garment along the foldline, keeping the turned under seam allowance intact. Pin turned-under seam allowance to garment. Slipstitch folded edge to the seamline, making certain that no stitches show through to the outside. Attach suitable fasteners to ends of waistband.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Faced Waistline

Skirt or trousers without visible waistbands are usually finished with a fabric facing

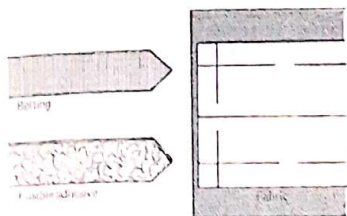
Waistline Casing

- Garments with elastic in a waistline casing are easy to sew and to pull on and off.
- The technique works on knit garments.

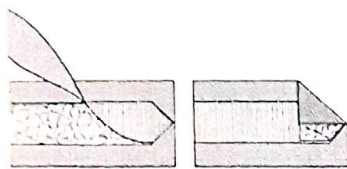
Belts

- Belts are usually made by covering belting with fashion fabric.
- Belting is available in several widths and may be purchased by the meter or an kit with a buckle.

Contour belts



To fuse: 1. Cut belting and two strips of fusible adhesive the length and width that the finished belt is to be. Shape one end of each of the strips into a point. Cut the belt fabric the length and twice the width of the belting.



2. Center a strip of adhesive, then the belting, on the wrong side of fabric. Follow manufacturer's directions to fuse layers. Cut a triangular piece of adhesive and place on belting point. Fold fabric over point and fuse point only.

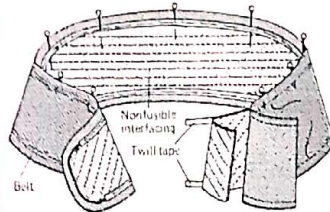


3. Fold long edges of fabric over belting and press. Insert fusible adhesive and cut away any adhesive not covered by fabric at the point. Fuse fabric in place. Attach buckle, work eyelets for a prong buckle (p.252).

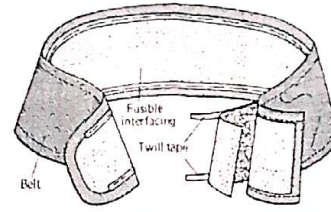


Because a contour belt is shaped to fit the curve of the body, regular straight belting cannot be used for backing. Use two layers of a sturdy interfacing, such as hair canvas (fusible or nonfusible). A separate shaped facing is required.

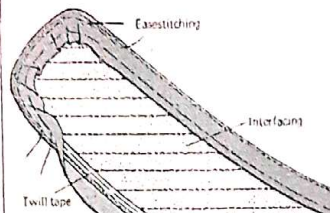
1. Cut all layers of the belt on the lengthwise grain. If non-fusible interfacing is being used, pin the two layers together and trace shape of finished belt onto one. Make rows of machine stitching within culline on lengthwise grain.



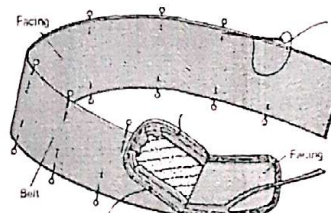
2. Cut the interfacing along the outline. Staystitch the belt along all outer edges. Center the padstitched interfacing on the belt, leaving a 1/4" margin on all sides; baste in place. Center and baste 1/4"-wide twill tape over seamlines.



If using fusible interfacing, cut two layers to size and shape of finished belt. Center one layer at a time on the wrong side of the belt, leaving 1/4" on all sides. Fuse in place. Center and baste 1/4"-wide twill tape over seamlines.



3. Apply a row of easestitching on seamline at curved end of belt. Press seam allowances to wrong side over interfacing, drawing up easestitching as needed so seam allowances lie flat. Hand-baste to interfacing with long stitches.



4. Staystitch belt facing and turn all edges in 3/4"; baste in place. Trim the seam allowances to 1/4". Pin the facing to the belt and slipstitch into place along all edges. Remove basting. Attach buckle, work eyelets for a prong buckle (p.252).

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Facings

Facings are an important part of the sewing process. They should be handled properly, ensuring that they are smooth and flat, without showing on the right side.

Facing adaptations

A simple facing is a piece of fabric cut in the same shape as the garment piece to which it is being sewn. Sometimes the facing is the same width as the garment piece, as in cuff or pocket flap facings; sometimes it is just a narrow strip, as in neckline or armhole facings.

Making a facing

- 1) Lay a piece of pattern paper over the garment edge to be faced. Trace around the edges and draw a lower facing line, so that the facing is about 3 inches wide. Use this traced-off pattern to cut the facing.

- 2) Some faced edges will include one or more darts; i.e. the back of the neck, or the waistline of a skirt or trousers. The dart should not be included in the facing, in order to reduce bulk.
- Fold out the dart and trace along the garment edges. Draw a lower facing line making the facing approximately 3 inches (76 mm) wide.
 - Sometimes it is advantageous to combine two facing pieces into one. This can save fabric, reduce bulk in the seam area, and simplify the construction process. Some facings that can be cut all-in-one are:
 - a) The back and front armhole facings, by eliminating the seam at the shoulder of the armhole facing;
 - b) The back and front neckline facings also eliminate the shoulder seam;

Armhole and neckline facings are found on sleeveless, scoop-necked garments. Separate facings tend to leave ridges that show through to the right side. Combining the facings gives a smoother finish.

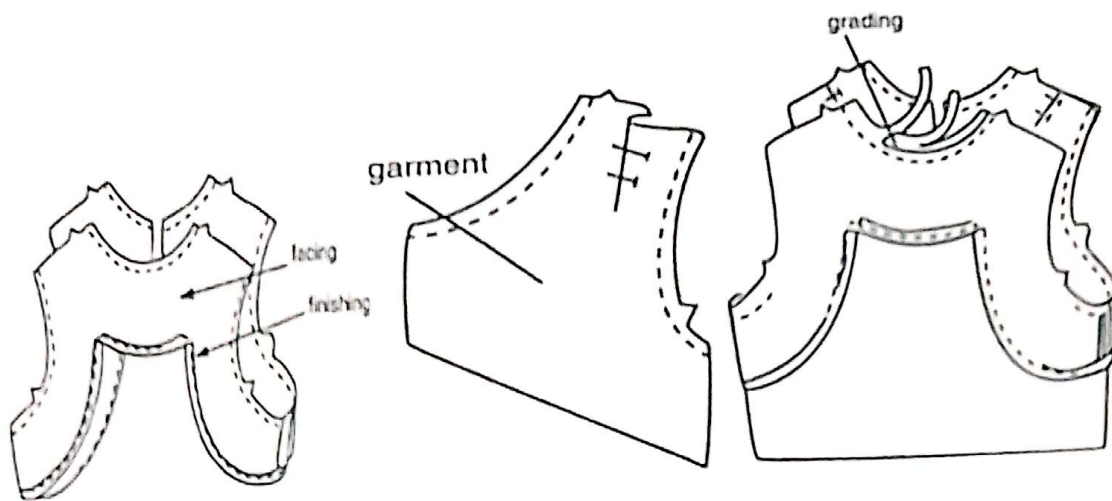
The garment front and front facing can be cut all-in-one when the front edge is a straight line. This gives one less seam and reduces the thickness of the garment front edge when working with a bulky fabric.

Facing Preparation

The free edge of the facing should be finished in some manner appropriate to the characteristics of the fabric and end garment. The chosen method should give the flattest finish. The facings should always be slightly smaller than the comparable garment piece so that the facing rolls to the underside and doesn't show around the finished edge. To ensure a smooth facing line trim all the interfacing close to the stitching line. Grade the seam allowances, average weight fabrics should be trimmed to about 6 mm, trim closer for thin fabrics and slightly wider for heavy fabrics. Seam allowances that lie just under the visible part of the garment should be left the longest. Curved areas should be clipped to the stay stitching or stitching line without cutting any threads. The clips should be perpendicular to the seam line and evenly spaced. Under-stitching keeps the facing in place and also gives a firm edge.

Combined Neckline-Armhole Facings

Among the methods for applying this combined facing is the *pull-through method*. This technique is used for garments that have a centre back or centre front opening and a finished shoulder width of at least 4 inches (10 cm). This width is necessary to allow the pulling the back section of the garment through the shoulder area without making the garment wrinkled. This technique is also used in fully lined vests.

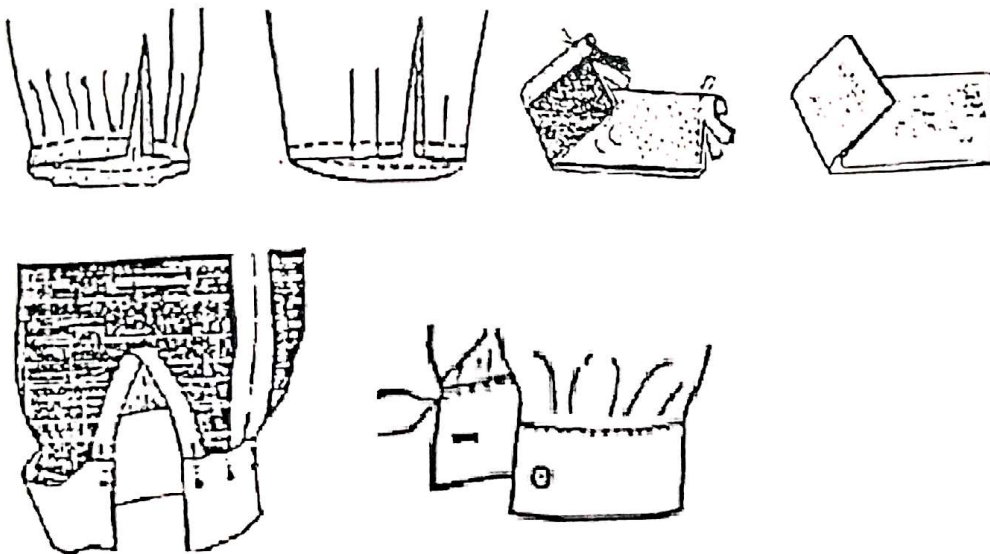


Waistline facings

Waistline facings can be used on skirts and trousers instead of a waistband finish. Faced waistlines are more comfortable to wear and also eliminate the problem of rolling waistbands.

Cuffs

Are interfaced and attached in a similar way as waistbands.



Hems

- Lower edges of garment units are usually finished with hems.
- Hems serve a different function from most other construction processes and are important to the overall appearance of the garment.

Characteristics of well-made hems

1. Inconspicuous on the RS except when the hem becomes part of the design, such as in sheer fabrics.
2. Hemline should be an appropriate distance from and parallel to the floor.
3. Hem width should be over and the appropriate depth for style and fabric.
4. Bulk should be removed from garment seams that fall within the hem.
5. Fullness should be eased in and evenly distributed for a flat, smooth finish.
6. Hemming stitches should be evenly spaced and securely attached to the fabric.
7. Type of hemming stitches used should be appropriate for the fabric.

Finishing Hems

- The choice of the hem finish depends on the fabric weight and its tendency to ravel, the depth of the hem, and the amount of fullness in the hem.
- Turning under the raw edge of the hem is a desirable finish for lightweight, washable fabrics.
- It is not suitable for fabrics that are bulky or that retain pressmark.
- If fabric ravel or is difficult to control the turned-under edge may be machine stitched before doing hand hemming.
- The raw edge of the hem may be left un-finished on firmly woven or knit fabrics that do not ravel.
- If the fabric ravel, the hem edge may be finished with seam binding or another suitable finish.
- A hem may be faced to reduce bulk when the lower edge of the hem is shaped or when there is insufficient fabric for a normal depth hem.
- Commercial bias hem facing of 5 cm (2") wide may be purchased or a similar facing may be cut from the fashion fabric or from a lining fabric.

Hemming Stitches

- Several kinds of stitches are suitable for hems.
- In using any hand hemming stitch, avoid pulling the thread too tight.
- The stitches may be done over the hem edge or between the hem and the outer fabric depending on the garment and fabric.
- The blind or slip-stitch is done under an edge through a folded edge.
- The catch stitch is used to hold the raw edges of interfacing in place along fold lines and to fasten facings at the seams and hem.
- If done between the hem and garment it can be used when hemming heavy fabric or fabrics that stretch, such as knits to prevent a ridge from showing on the RS of the garment.
- The Lock stitch is a type of blanket stitch done between the hem and the outer fabric.

- Machine stitch may be used on garments in which conspicuous hems are not a disadvantage.

Summary

Hems and edge finishes add final touches to your garments. Hems should never show on the right side unless you are making a decorative finish. Various fabrics and garment styles require different hem techniques. Edge finishes can be used instead of conventional hems on many garments especially knits. The edge finishes are also applicable around sleeveless armholes, necklines, and the front edges of coats and jackets.

The length of a garment will be dictated by the current trend in fashion, but it is important that a hem lies flat and is even all the way round. Before turning a hem, the length should be checked. The garment should be tried on, and the position of the hemline marked with tailor's chalk or pins, by another person. The position of the hemline or fitting line should then be marked with flat tacking stitches. Suggested hem widths are given in the chart below.

Type of garment	Style/design	Size of hem/fold
Dress or skirt	Straight	2.5-3 in (64-76 mm)
	A-Line	1.5-3 in (38-50 mm)
	Full	0.5-1 in (13-25 mm)
Trousers		1.5-2 in (38-50 mm)
Shirts and tops	Tuck-in	0.25-0.5 (6-13 mm)
	Pull over	1-1.5 in (25-38 mm)
Sleeves		1-1.5 in (25-38 mm)
Jackets and Coats	Lightweight	1.5-2 in (38-50 mm)
	Heavyweight	2-3 in (50-76 mm)

There are two basic hemming techniques, the flat finish and the inside hem. The flat finish has the edge sewn flat to the garment. The hem is stitched in place with the blind stitch, catchstitch or slipstitch. The inside hem finish has the stitches between the garment and the hem fabric using either the catchstitch or the blind stitch.

Never use double thread when hemming.

- Lay the garment flat on the wrong side
- Fold over the hem allowance to 6 mm along the fitting line.
- Pin at right angles to the fitting line.
- With a loose stitch, tack 1 cm from the fitting line.
- Allowing approximately 5 cm width for the hem, cut away any excess material. On children's clothes a hem should be 10 cm.
- Press the hem lightly on the wrong side.
- Neaten the raw edge

Most paper patterns indicate the type of finish that should be used.

- i. A straight plain hem is suitable for lightweight fabrics, where the skirt is not flared.
- ii. A bound hem is suitable for thick fabrics which fray easily.
- iii. A herring-bone hem is used for thick fabrics which do not fray.
- iv. A false hem is used when there is an inadequate hem allowance, or where a garment needs lengthening. Very bulky fabrics can be finished with this method, using a lightweight fabric for the false hem.
- v. A non-sew iron-on hemming strip can be used for fabrics which are not affected by a hot iron. Always test a fusible hemming strip on a small piece of the fabric before starting to hem.
- vi. Fullness can be "shrunk" away on woollen fabrics. The edge can then be finished with Paris binding.
- vii. The fake cuff hem is used on woven and knit fabrics. It gives the appearance of a separate cuff, although it is just a special way of turning and stitching the hem. It is used on short-sleeved shirts at the lower edge of trousers and across the top of a patch pocket.
- viii. The fake band hem is used on sleeves and lower edges of sport shorts and casual knit tops. It gives the appearance of a separate band finish.
- ix. The rolled hem is ideal for lightweight knits, it gives a narrow roll finish to an edge.

Fasteners

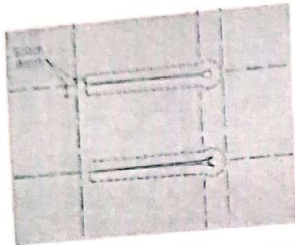
Buttonholes

Keyhole buttonholes

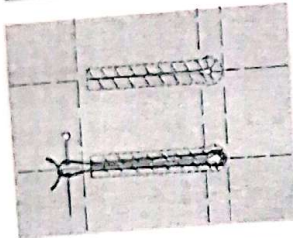
The tailored worked buttonhole, or keyhole buttonhole, is similar to the horizontal hand-worked buttonhole on the preceding page. The difference is an eyelet, or enlarged "resting place" for the button shank at one end instead of the usual fan arrangement of stitches. By providing more room

for the shank, the eyelet ensures that the buttonhole will not be distorted when the garment is buttoned. This makes the tailored buttonhole the best choice for men's jackets and other finely tailored garments. Remember, on a man's coat or jacket, buttonholes are placed on the opposite

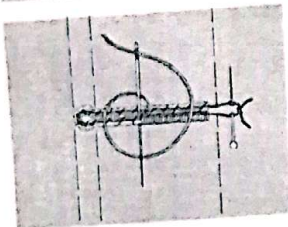
side from the side used for women's garments. Use a single strand of buttonhole twist or heavy duty thread for buttonhole stitches. For a perfect angled touch, it is suggested that a tailored worked buttonhole be corded. The filler can be heavy-duty thread, buttonhole twist, or fine string.



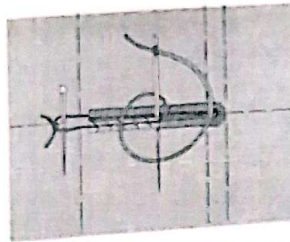
1. Machine stitch at 20 stitches per inch around the buttonhole. The stitch depth away from the buttonhole position, one and one-half inches. There are two ways to open the buttonhole and make it look as if it is cut along the top line one inch from the buttonhole. One is to cut along the top line one inch from the buttonhole and the other is to cut along the top line one inch from the buttonhole and the other is to cut along the top line one inch from the buttonhole.



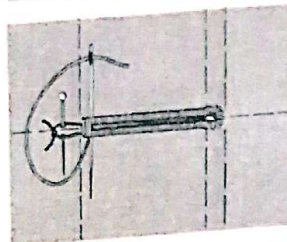
2. Overcast the edges of the slash by hand. If the buttonhole is to be corded, cut a length of cord and knot it to fit loosely around the buttonhole. Place the cord around the buttonhole so that the knot is at the end that will be tail-faxed, secure with pins. Overcast as above, enclosing the cord in the stitching.



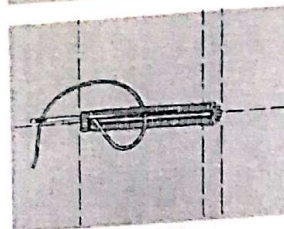
3. Work the buttonhole stitches with the keyhole opening at the left when work begins. Use the machine stitching as a guide for stitch depth. For each stitch, be sure thread from the needle eye goes around and under needle point. To form a pull on the edge, draw the needle straight up. Place stitches close together so that the edge is covered with pulls.



4. Continue the buttonhole stitches around the keyhole, keeping the pulls close together along the edge. To form a smooth line, the stitches may have to be turned slightly apart around the corner. Turn the buttonhole. At work progress, and cover the edge completely with buttonhole stitches.



5. To make a bar tack at the unfinished end, take several long stitches across the end to equal the combined width of the rows of buttonhole stitches. Work blanket stitches across these long stitches, catching in fabric while making, and keeping thread from previous stitch under the point of the needle with each new stitch.

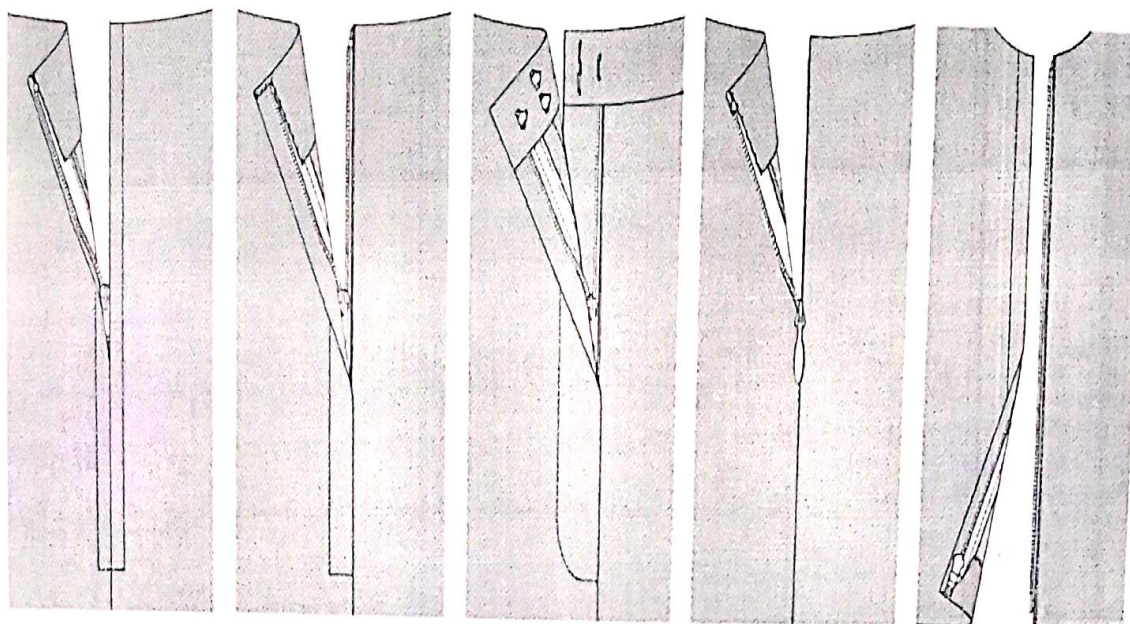


6. Cover long stitches completely with blanket stitches. When finished, fasten the thread on the underside. Pull slightly on the tied ends of the cord so the buttonhole looks smooth and taut. Tie a new knot if necessary. Cut off excess cord and tuck knot into bar tack.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Zip Fasteners

Basic applications



Centered: Application involving a conventional zipper. Used at center front or back of garment, at edges of sleeves, in home decorating.

Lapped: This application, too, takes a conventional zipper. Most often used at the left side seam of pants, skirts, and dresses.

Fly-front: The traditional trouser application, it is now used on women's pants and skirts. Requires a conventional zipper.

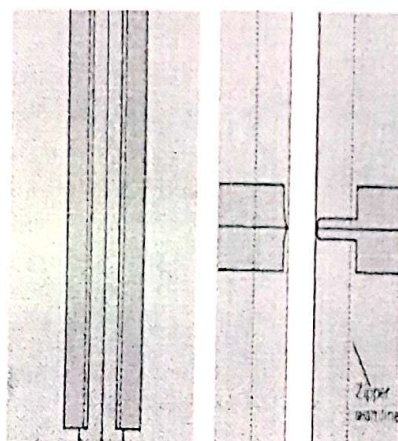
Invisible: Possible only with the special invisible zipper, this application can substitute for either a lapped or centered application.

Separating: The separating zipper may be sewed in with either a centered or lapped application. Usable on jackets, vests, or skirts.

Installation tips

Before any zipper is sewed into a garment, the placket seam should be seam-finished and then, in most cases, basted and pressed open. Staystitch any curved or bias placket seamlines $\frac{1}{4}$ " from the cut edge to prevent possible stretching. Preshrink the zipper to avoid puckering after laundering. Immerse zipper in hot tap water for a few minutes, roll in a towel to absorb excess moisture, then allow to air-dry. If you expect a great deal of shrinkage from the fabric, preshrink the zipper twice.

Use of a zipper adhesive eliminates basting and pinning, and is excellent for fabrics that show needle and pin punctures. It is basically a double-faced tape; for use, see information accompanying the product.



Enlarging seam allowances: This is necessary if they are less than $\frac{1}{4}$ " wide. Edgestitch woven seam binding to edge of seam allowances only.

Reduce bulk in cross-seam allowances: as for example, yokes and waistlines. Trim seam allowances slightly past zipper seamline as shown, and press open.

To shorten a zipper: whipstitch several times over coil or chain as shown, 1" below desired new length, then cut off the excess zipper and tapes.

For dress placket use, a zipper must be closed above the top stop. Whipstitch the edges of the tapes together $\frac{1}{4}$ " above top stop, or attach a straight-eye fastener.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Fasteners

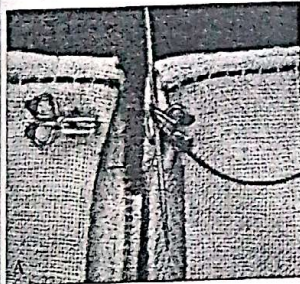
Wherever two garment edges meet, a fastener is needed to hold the edges together. Besides buttons and buttonholes, the most common type, there are many other choices. Here's a useful array of fasteners, conventional and otherwise. Some are sewn in place, while others are attached with simple tools.

To mark the fastener placement on your garment, line up the garment edges evenly and use pins to mark the placement.

Hooks and Eyes

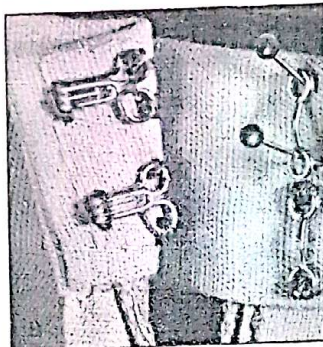
These metal fasteners are used to hold edges very securely where there may be some strain. They range in size from 0 to 4, for light to heavyweight fabrics and many fastening needs. The hooks come with loop and straight eyes.

For edges that meet: Use a hook and loop eye. On the inside, sew the hook $\frac{1}{8}$ " (3 mm) from the right-hand edge, making a few tacking stitches through the holes. Also sew across the end, under the hook, to hold it flat. Don't let the stitches show on the outside of the garment. Sew the eye opposite the hook, letting it



extend slightly beyond the garment edge. Take a few stitches along the sides of the loop to hold it flat (A).

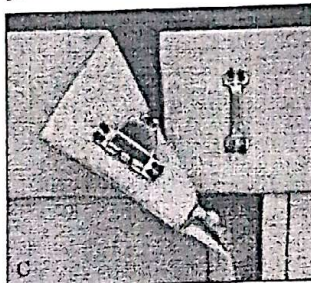
For edges that lap: Use a hook and straight eye. For a waistband, sew on two sets. Sew the hook(s) to the inside of the garment on the overlapping side, $\frac{1}{8}$ " (3 mm) from



the edge, making a few tacking stitches through the holes. Also sew across the end(s), under the hook(s), to hold it flat. Don't let stitches for the hook show on the outside of the garment. Close the zipper or other closure to mark the eye position(s) with pins. Sew the eye(s) to the outside of the underlap (B).

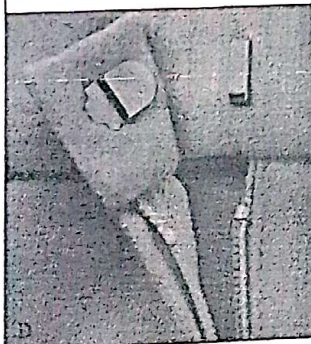
Heavy Duty Waistband Hook and Eye

A large, flat metal hook and eye is a great fastener for most skirt and pants waistbands. It's large



enough for you to use only one set, thin enough to be inconspicuous, yet sturdy enough to take almost any strain (C). Apply it like the regular hook and eye, above.

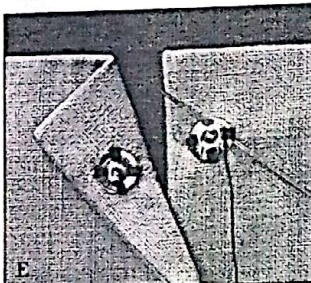
No-sew type: This waistband hook and eye hammers or clamps on—stitch-free. Apply it before you finish the waistband, following the manufacturer's instructions (D).



Snaps

These fasteners should be used only where there will be very little strain. They come in many sizes for light to heavyweight fabrics and different fastening needs, and are used where edges lap.

Sew-on types: Sew the ball half of the snap to the overlapping section on the inside of the garment, about $\frac{1}{8}$ " (3 mm) from the edge. Make several tacking stitches through each hole, carrying the thread under the snap to the next hole without letting stitches show



on the outside. To mark the position of the socket half of the snap on the outside of the underlapping section, close the garment and use a pin stuck through the socket. Sew the socket in place the same way you did the ball half (E).

(Source: Simplicity Sewing Book)